

# WILL OS X = IOS?

**How much of the Jony Ive influence will OS X see in 2013?**

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**F**or Apple, 2013 will be big. The advantage of Apple products till now was because of the complete package – the hardware and software is neatly optimised. Some criticised the closed ecosystem, but the tight leash Apple has on both aspects translates to performance. The idea seems to be fairly simple – bring the desktop and the smartphone OS as close to each other as possible. The reason is two-pronged: collaboration and consistency. But with rivals trying even harder, the gap between competitors is surely closing. To be honest, Apple after Steve Jobs just hasn't been able to wow users as they used to be able to, and the Cupertino wizards desperately need something to set the bar high again. They still make good products, but none of them path-breaking.

## The future of OS X?

Some say that the best job in the world is to be a Porsche designers. They have 3 models, all of them similar, and they hardly ever change anything noticeable, except under the hood, but that's engineering, not design. Similarly, Apple seems to have taken a similar approach for OSes. "Timeless brilliance", some may say, or "if it's not broken, why fix it?"

The year 2012 saw the Mountain Lion OS X update – Lion's successor. Lion was touted to be a genuine successor to Snow Leopard, however, it seems Mountain Lion is the real successor, as it actually implements the idea of Lion. So what was this idea? Put simply, bring the desktop and the smartphone OS closer.

First up, the Launchpad is the iOS style application menu on the desktop. With Mountain Lion, there is the notification bar, just as you would have on a phone. Facebook and Twitter integration followed, joining the likes of Vimeo and

Flickr on the OS X platform. While this may not look like much, the ability to send a status update or tweet a photograph like you would on a phone just makes the desktop OS feel closer to the sweet spot. Game Centre is another application that made its way over from iOS devices – to create a complete ecosystem of seamless gaming, at least for the titles that support it. Voice commands and typing – Dictation is now available for multiple apps, including the popular office suites.

The biggest update was iCloud, that let you sync contacts, documents, mails etc. between your devices – the Mac, the iPhone and the iPad. The syncing is instant. You can create a document on Pages on your MacBook and edit it on Pages on the iPad on the train ride back home. Scribble a Note for later, and it'll be there on your other devices as well. If you happen to misplace one of the devices, Find My Mac and Find My Phone will do the finding via the iCloud web site.

Not everything is perfect though. One thing that perplexes everyone is that the same operating system update works brilliantly on one MacBook, while others with the exact same generation machine will report slower performance, poor battery life and other compatibility issues. This holds true for the last two OS refreshes – Lion and Mountain Lion – which is worrisome!

It's not just the older generation hardware that faces issues either, but even spanking new Macbooks report the same niggles. Not something one would expect from Apple, especially since their closed and complete control over the hardware and software is what's supposed to make their products good to begin with!



Launchpad brings the OS X closer to the iOS